

TEACH FROM THE SITE. LEARN THROUGH THE BOOK.

Desk Tidy

Teacher guide

Companion to the 50-page student workbook | Editorial edition 2.0

Use the workbook as the student reading and evidence resource while you teach from the matching course section, presentation, clip or physical demonstration. The student pages deliberately combine short theory, source illustrations, discussion, application and practical records. They can be completed without individual student screen use.

The controlled print edition

50

student pages

25

double-sided sheets

A4

long-edge flip

Print the student PDF on A4, double-sided, flipping on the long edge. Fifty printed pages use 25 sheets, including the cover. Print at actual size where practical; the drawing grids are guides and must not be used to infer project dimensions. Colour helps the material images, but the page design remains usable in greyscale. Bind or staple on the left. The editable Word copy may repaginate on other computers; use the PDF for the controlled print edition.

A manageable lesson routine

Identify the matching reading. Explain one idea using the site, slides, sample or demonstration. Ask students to annotate or discuss the relevant picture, then complete the paper task. Check a small sample of explanations before moving to practice. Use the existing website quizzes for optional feedback or whole-class retrieval when it serves the lesson.

The PDF is the controlled 50-page edition. Use the editable Word copy for adaptation; its pagination may change with fonts, software or edits.

PLANNING AND DELIVERY

The course at a glance

Module	Pages	Learning focus	Course route
1	3-10	Brief, safety and materials	weeks1-2/
2	11-18	Research and design development	weeks3-4/
3	19-26	Drawings, planning and marking out	weeks5-6/
4	27-34	Production, joinery and assembly	weeks7-8/
5	35-42	Finishing, testing and evaluation	weeks9-10/

Shared resources to prepare

Have the current induction and approved drawing requirements ready. Provide safe material samples and teacher-approved research examples or printed source extracts, particularly for respectful Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander design research. Use the site video library or your demonstration when the workbook asks students to observe a process. No student is required to independently search for a clip or cultural source.

Source and practical boundaries

This is a selected and adapted companion, not a printout of every website question. It follows all fifteen named theory sections and the twelve folio evidence categories. Current teacher directions, local induction, OnGuard where applicable, SOPs, workshop controls and product instructions govern practical work. No completed construction plan or component dimensions are supplied. The source specifies 1:10 orthographic drawings with actual millimetre dimensions plus an isometric view; check drawing accuracy before production. The original project PDF contains superseded assessment weightings, which have deliberately not been reproduced. Use the issued task notification for formal assessment and submission.

Course home: stevencowell.github.io/desk-tidy/

Video library: </youtube-library/video-library.html>

Project folio: </desk-tidy-folio.html>

MODULE 1 / SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Brief, safety and materials

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. These notes support teaching; they are not a formal marking rubric.

Page / question	Suggested answer and discussion
5 / Q1	B. Visible natural grain
5 / Q2	C. Evidence for a decision
9 / Q3	C. Explain the need and user
9 / Q4	D. Stays stable as items are removed
9 / Q5	B. Eliminating the hazard
9 / Q6	D. Stop and report it

Applied activities

Safety chain. 1 H; 2 R; 3 C; 4 P; 5 F. Repair: do not use damaged equipment; stop and report it to the teacher. Safety glasses do not remove the hazard or make the equipment safe. Do not ask another student to test it.

Materials classification. 1 E; 2 A; 3 U; 4 E; 5 A; 6 U. Suitable repairs: MDF suitability depends on the approved design and project requirements; sustainable timber use also depends on sourcing, efficient use and waste.

Text hunt. Dimensions should come from the items and workspace rather than the example image. Waste actions include selecting suitable stock, planning the component layout, accurate marking and keeping usable offcuts.

Extended response. Look for a specific teacher-demonstrated process; accurate hazard/risk distinction; controls from different levels, including a suitable physical control, instruction/authorisation and PPE; explanation that PPE does not remove the hazard; stop/report response. This response does not prove practical authorisation.

MODULE 2 / SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Research and design development

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. These notes support teaching; they are not a formal marking rubric.

Page / question	Suggested answer and discussion
12 / Q1	C. Review and refine using evidence
13 / Q2	D. Pause and ask the teacher
17 / Q3	B. Different layouts or forms
17 / Q4	C. Recording features and sources
17 / Q5	A. A reason linked to evidence
17 / Q6	B. A suitable model used with intended items

Applied activities

Sequence puzzle. B > D > F > E > A > C. Source integrity: D. Measurable design information: A.

Matrix. Totals are out of 20 using five criteria. Individual scores and the selected design vary; reasons must connect to criteria and evidence. Important weaknesses, constraints and feedback may outweigh the total.

Respectful research. Responses should identify a teacher-approved source and its context, record attribution, check authority and reuse conditions, and describe an original application of a suitable broad principle without copying cultural expression.

Extended response. Look for a named preferred concept, criterion-based matrix reasons, test result, feedback, refinement and realistic consideration of material, time, skill or process constraints. Teacher approval is still required before further development or production.

MODULE 3 / SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Drawings, planning and marking out

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. These notes support teaching; they are not a formal marking rubric.

Page / question	Suggested answer and discussion
22 / Q1	B. One drawn unit represents ten actual units. Scale controls drawn size; written dimensions describe actual intended size.
22 / Q2	C. Use written dimensions on the approved drawing; photocopy size is not a dependable production reference.
22 / Q3	A. Part name, quantity, material and exact dimensions from the approved drawing.
22 / Q4	D. Stop, re-establish the datum and compare the marks with the approved drawing. A partner cannot authorise cutting.

Applied activities

Drawing language. In table order: orthographic; isometric; dimension; scale; millimetres. Accept equivalent accurate wording.

Scale practice. 240 mm becomes 24 mm; 90 mm becomes 9 mm; 150 mm becomes 15 mm. These are practice numbers only. The drawing/cutting-list conflict is unresolved: do not assume either 240 or 204 is correct. Compare the authoritative approved drawing and obtain teacher clarification before correcting the list or marking material.

Stop or check. In table order: CHECK; STOP; STOP; CHECK. STOP corrections: clarify orientation and mark waste against the approved drawing; locate the approved drawing and verify the dimension. CHECK means evidence ready for checking, not permission to cut.

Extended response guidance. A strong response explains that a concept sketch does not provide complete production information. Complete and approve orthographic/isometric drawings with written millimetre dimensions; derive and check the cutting list; plan dependencies, milestones and contingency; mark from a reliable datum and verify orientation and waste. It connects each check to reduced error, waste or rework and recognises teacher approval before production. Do not require one fixed set of project dimensions.

MODULE 4 / SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Production, joinery and assembly

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. These notes support teaching; they are not a formal marking rubric.

Page / question	Suggested answer and discussion
30 / Q1	C. Keep the kerf on the waste side to protect the wanted component and retain the line as a reference.
30 / Q2	A. A rebate has a step or recess that helps locate the connected part.
30 / Q3	D. Stop, investigate the fault and obtain teacher guidance rather than using glue or pressure to conceal it.
30 / Q4	B. 80 > 120 > 240 grit, unless the teacher directs otherwise. Start only when curing, product instructions and teacher authorisation allow.

Applied activities

Joint detective. In table order: B, D, R, B, D, R. Joint comparison is not an instruction to use a particular joint in the actual design.

Fault diagnosis. Binding saw: stop rather than force; seek teacher guidance to check setup, security, tool condition and alignment as appropriate. Gap: inspect mating edges, seating, orientation and approved dimensions with the teacher; resolve before glue. Movement during clamping: stop and seek guidance on positioning and controlled pressure; recheck square and alignment. Accept plausible checks, not an unsupported claim of one definite cause. All faults can become more difficult to correct after adhesive fixes the relationship.

Assembly sequence. Correct letter order: C, E, A, F, D, B. Numbers beside the displayed rows: A=3, B=6, C=1, D=5, E=2, F=4. Underline E; dry fit and its resolved faults/approval precede PVA.

Extended response guidance. A strong response identifies the gap as evidence needing diagnosis before glue, not a confirmed diagnosis. It explains full dry fit and teacher approval; controlled clamping without using excessive pressure to hide poor fit; rechecking because parts can move; and authorised 80/120/240 surface preparation after curing. It explains that finer abrasive does not conceal unresolved coarse marks or joint faults. Accept teacher-directed variations and do not invent adhesive curing time.

MODULE 5 / SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Finishing, testing and evaluation

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. These notes support teaching; they are not a formal marking rubric.

Page / question	Suggested answer and discussion
40 / Q1	B - Product instructions and teacher approval determine readiness. A finish can be touch-dry before it has developed enough strength for use.
40 / Q2	C - One coat of water-based clear varnish is the project-unit specification. The actual product and current local procedure remain teacher controlled.
40 / Q3	D - Removing and returning intended items without obstruction is observable evidence directly related to access.
40 / Q4	A - Retain the result, diagnose a possible cause and obtain teacher approval before any physical adjustment.
40 / Q5	C - This recognises a benefit and a resource cost while identifying a practical waste-reduction opportunity.

Applied activities

Finish detective. A: even coverage; fairly consistent sheen without a local ridge or gathered liquid. B: run; a visible vertical trail and rounded drop. C: pooling; accumulated finish along the inside corner. These identify visible features, not permission to repair.

Evidence or opinion. (a) O; (b) E, provided the measurement was actually made; (c) E. For (b), stronger evidence records the actual footprint and available space.

Evaluation pathway. Left to right: 1 criterion; 2 evidence; 3 judgement; 4 improvement; 5 reflection. 'My Desk Tidy is great' offers an unsupported judgement; it gives no stated criterion, evidence, improvement or reflection.

Open responses. Responses vary. Look for teacher-directed finish preparation and handling; test methods using intended items; specific observations against original criteria; justified judgements; one limitation and realistic improvement; authentic skill development and sustainability trade-offs. Do not treat hypothetical model results as student evidence.

EVIDENCE AND PROVENANCE

Completing the folio

Pages 43-49 provide reusable working spaces for drawings, a cutting list, schedule, journal and authentic images. Page 50 maps all twelve evidence categories back to the workbook. Students identify existing evidence instead of rewriting everything. A photograph should show a useful check and have an explanatory caption; a labelled sketch or teacher-observed check is an appropriate paper alternative. Confirm any formal evidence requirements from the current task notification.

Judge the explanation and the evidence

Accept accurate alternatives supported by the source and the student's actual design. Open design, sample, practical and evaluation tasks have no single model answer. Assess the reasoning and evidence. Suggested answers in this guide are teaching support, not a formal marking rubric.

Source record

Adapted from the current main-branch Desk Tidy course downloaded on 10 September 2026. Primary course inputs: the five module index pages and lesson-data files; the project unit PDF; activity and reading data; the folio evidence sequence; and the course source map. Existing course photographs and teaching illustrations are credited to the course assets. This editorial edition adds generated illustrative photographs and bespoke labelled vector diagrams. They are teaching examples, not photographs of actual student work, approved project plans or instructions establishing component dimensions. New paper tasks and record sheets support the same learning sequence and preserve its stated content boundaries.

Using the new editorial visuals

Treat photographs as material and design observations, and diagrams as explanations of the named principle. Where students draw, plan, make or record results, they must use their own work, the approved drawing and actual observations. A realistic-looking illustration does not establish that a particular construction, tool setup or finish is approved for the class.

Edition record

Editorial edition 2.0 | Prepared 10 September 2026

Student master: 50 A4 pages, printed double-sided on 25 sheets.

Teacher guide: eight pages, with all 25 multiple-choice answers and applied activity notes.

Editable Word companion: provided for adaptation and may reflow.